

Chicago Tribune



QUESTIONS? CALL 1-800-TRIBUNE

FRIDAY, AUGUST 8, 2025

BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

FBI agrees to help find Texas Dems

Pritzker calls GOP move ‘grandstanding,’ says there’s no law allowing arrest of the lawmakers

By Rick Pearson
and Jeremy Gorner
Chicago Tribune

Democratic Gov. JB Pritzker accused Republicans of “grandstanding” Thursday after Texas GOP U.S. Sen. John Cornyn said the FBI granted his request that they assist Texas law enforcement in locating House Democrats who fled the southern state, many of them to west suburban St. Charles.

“The reality is that all that he has said, Cornyn, is that the FBI has been authorized to locate the

Texas House Democrats, nothing more. And you know why? Because there is no federal law that allows them to arrest Texas Democrats who are here visiting the state of Illinois,” Pritzker said in Springfield after cutting the ribbon to open the Illinois State Fair.

“I welcome the FBI coming to the state,” the Illinois governor said. “I hope they take in the state fair. I hope they go see the beauty of Lake Michigan, the adventure awaits for all of them. But they won’t be arresting anyone.”

It was unclear what the FBI’s

activities would entail since the Texas lawmakers have not been charged with state- or federal-level criminal activity. They are facing civil warrants for leaving the state, but they are unenforceable outside of Texas.

As for locating the Texas lawmakers, the bulk of them were staying at the same hotel in far west suburban St. Charles, where they went after arriving at Chicago’s O’Hare International Airport on Sunday night. Their hotel was the subject of a bomb threat Wednesday that caused them to be evacuated during a search that turned up nothing. There were no reports of



Gov. JB Pritzker speaks alongside Gene Wu, right, the Texas House Democratic Caucus chair, and other Texas Democrats on Sunday after their arrival in Carol Stream. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Turn to Texas, Page 2



TERRENCE ANTONIO JAMES/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Ella French honored

Elizabeth French, center, looks up in front of the Leighton Criminal Court Building in Chicago at the honorary street sign named for her daughter, slain Chicago police Officer Ella French, during a ceremony on Thursday.

Tariffs take effect on more than 60 countries

US economy shows signs of concern as trade war escalates

By Josh Boak
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — President Donald Trump began imposing higher import taxes on dozens of countries Thursday just as the economic fallout of his monthslong tariff threats has begun to cause visible damage to the U.S. economy.

Just after midnight, goods from more than 60 countries and the European Union became subject to tariff rates of 10% or higher. Products from the EU, Japan and South Korea are taxed at 15%, while imports from Taiwan, Vietnam and Bangladesh are taxed at 20%. Trump also expects the EU, Japan and South Korea to invest hundreds of billions of dollars in the United States.

“I think the growth is going to be unprecedented,” Trump said Wednesday. He said the U.S. was “taking in hundreds of billions of dollars in tariffs,” but did not provide a specific figure for revenues because “we don’t even know what the final number is” regarding the rates.

Despite the uncertainty, the White House is confident that the onset of his tariffs will provide clarity about the path for the world’s largest economy. Now that companies understand the direction the

Turn to Tariffs, Page 8



Swimmers start a race in the water off Ohio Street Beach in September. **BRIAN CASSELLA/TRIBUNE**

City OKs first Chicago River open-water swim in a century

Last year’s event had to be relocated to Lake Michigan

By Adriana Pérez
Chicago Tribune

Before hundreds of swimmers are set to jump into the Chicago River in September, organizers and advocates say they are taking a “victory lap” of their own.

On Thursday, the city of Chicago approved the first official open-water swim to take place in its urban waterway in almost a century. A city spokesperson said the permit

process was still in progress. This comes after 13 years of planning, and after last year’s event had to be relocated to Lake Michigan when, just two months out, transportation officials denied a permit citing safety concerns.

“This is, really, a long time coming,” said Doug McConnell, organizer of the Chicago River Swim and founder of A Long Swim, an area nonprofit that will produce the event to fund Northwestern University research for ALS, a fatal neurological disorder known also as Lou Gehrig’s disease. “It’s been a lot of pick-and-shovel, hard work, and people really

dedicated to a common goal and outcome.”

To address safety, organizers said they will deploy over 100 safety personnel — with 40 lifeguards, or one for every seven swimmers — to monitor the course on kayaks, paddleboards, jet skis, rowboats and power boats. Participants will also wear an electronic GPS chip on their ankles and autonomous buoys so that organizers can account for their position on the course, which the U.S. Coast Guard will close to vessels. Riverwalk access will also be limited to specific

Turn to Swim, Page 4

Potential closure of Weiss stirs concerns

The Uptown hospital slated to lose Medicare funding over weekend

By Lisa Schencker
and Katherine Weaver
Chicago Tribune

With just days to go before Weiss Memorial Hospital was scheduled to lose Medicare funding, concerns swirled Thursday about whether the hospital was about to close.

Dr. Manoj Prasad, the head of the company that owns the hospital, and other hospital officials did not respond to requests for comment Thursday. But three hospital staffers, who asked to remain unnamed, told the Tribune that they’d been told the hospital would close at 7 a.m. Friday.

The Uptown hospital’s hallways were mostly empty Thursday morning. The emergency waiting room was deserted, and some of the offices and waiting rooms had signs reading “permanently closed.” A white folding table at the entrance of Weiss held four flyers with instructions for patients about how to get medical records, ask billing questions and find their doctors at other locations.

A man wearing scrubs walked through a hospital entrance Thursday morning carrying cardboard boxes.

“It’s devastating,” said Marianne Lalonde, an Uptown resident and past president of the Lakeside Area Neighbors Association, of the possible closure. “It serves a population that is really in need. I

Turn to Weiss, Page 4

INSIDE

All eyes are on the Bears quarterback

In a recent sit-down with the Tribune, Caleb Williams talked about his union with Ben Johnson, his development and his outlook for this season. **Chicago Sports**

Israel makes plan to seize all of Gaza

Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu says Israel would transfer administration to friendly Arab countries. **Nation & World**

TODAY’S WEATHER

High **91**
Low **75**



Complete Chicagoland forecast on Business, Page 8

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
178th year No. 220
© Chicago Tribune

